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The hottest new tech trend is slower texting, and it actually makes sense

Why people are willingly sending messages by digital pigeons, snails and penguins.

By Varun Mirchandani Published August 24, 2026

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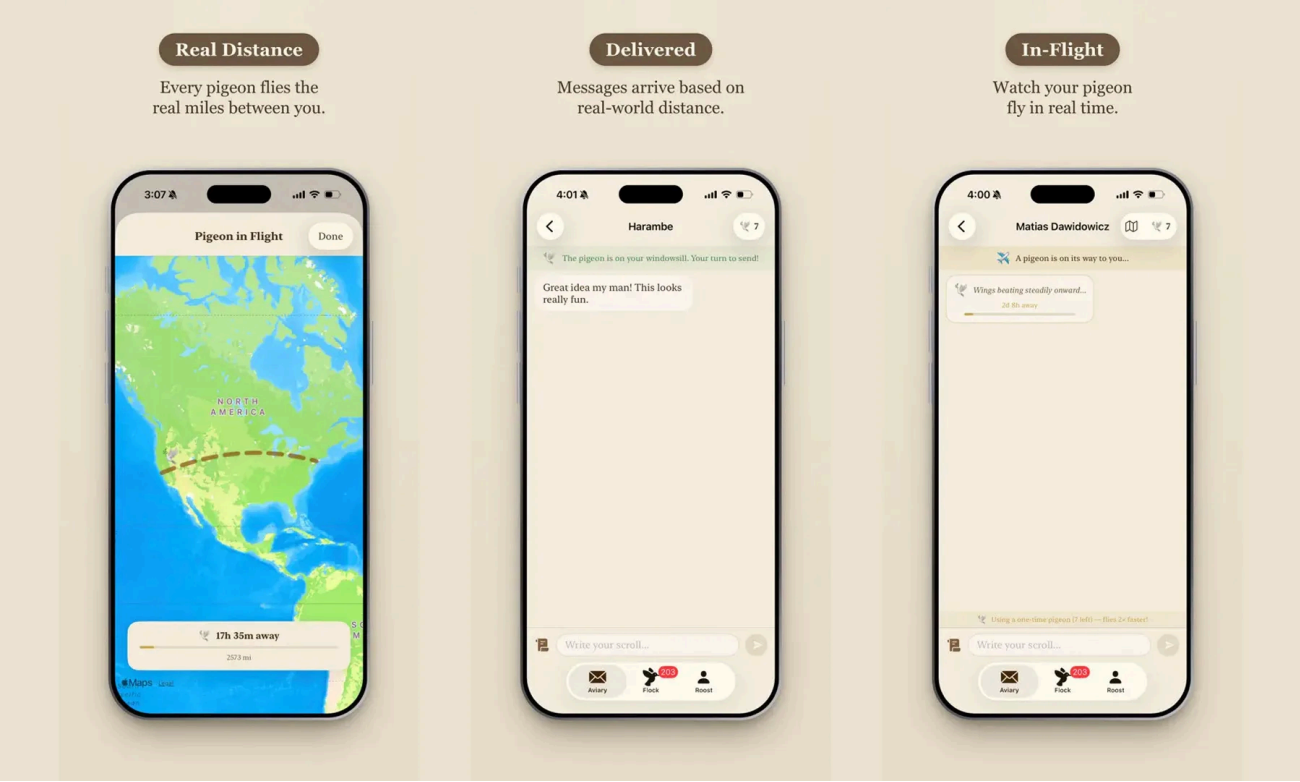
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For decades, tech has been obsessed with making communication faster. Now, apparently, we've had enough. As *The New York Times* reports, the latest trend is slow tech, with apps like Carrier Pidge and Roost deliberately making messages take minutes, hours or even longer to arrive. Yes, we're talking about digital carrier

pigeons. Carrier Pidge launched in April and recently jumped from a few hundred users to more than 75,000, while Roost reportedly reached 650,000 downloads this month.

Apparently, waiting is cool again

Carrier Pidge lets you send a message via a digital pigeon whose journey you can track on a map. Its speed is based on real racing pigeons, topping out at 110mph, and there's even a tiny 0.2% chance your bird disappears, meaning you'll have to cough up 99 cents for a replacement. Roost takes the idea even further, offering more than 1,000 animals, from pigeons and penguins to snails that crawl along at a wonderfully useless pace.



Carrier Pidge App | Carrier Pidge

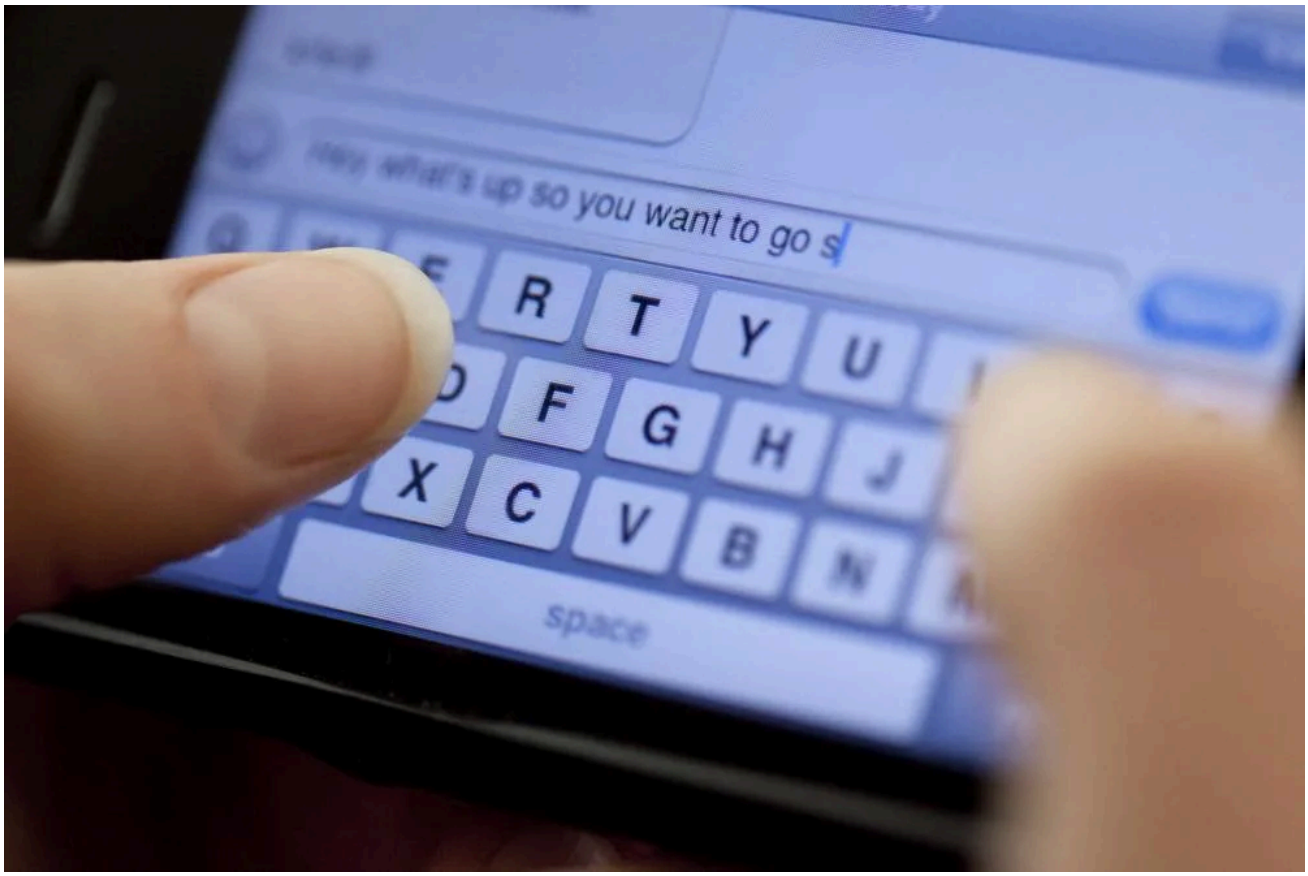
The appeal isn't really the wildlife. It's the friction. Instead of another instant notification demanding your attention, you actually have to wait for someone to respond. That may actually matter more than we think: research has suggested that constantly picking up your phone in short bursts can be more mentally taxing than simply spending a long stretch on it. Carrier Pidge's 29-year-old creator, Noah Iarrobino, previously made an app that charged users 99 cents every time they hit snooze, while Roost creator Logan Mendelsohn comes from the trust-and-safety tech world and is now planning to hire as the app grows.

Maybe our phones got a little too good at being phones

There may actually be something behind the silliness. A 2023 survey found that 80% of Gen Z adults, defined in the survey as people born after 1997, worried their

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can process it.



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And people aren't just tolerating the slowness — they're embracing it. One user told The New York Times that she and her friends even started writing to each other in Bridgerton-esque language, calling one another *"my dearest lady."*

After decades of making everything faster, maybe the next killer feature really is making us wait. And honestly, if sending a text by pigeon is what it takes to make our phones a little less exhausting, perhaps we shouldn't laugh at the birds just yet.

Varun Mirchandani

Varun is an experienced technology journalist and editor with over eight years in consumer tech media. His work spans...

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